G I R L
F R A M E

// the vital frontier //

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a setting zine
girls . frames . gorgons . the council
and the hundred-year vigil

100 years after the coup
the Angels rule . the Princess waits

THE PITCH

Generations after Luminara's founding, the technocrats ousted the Princess and became the COUNCIL OF ANGELS. They tore a hole in space reaching for the stars. The GORGONS came through.

Now girls pilot half-living FRAMES against the Gorgon threat. The Frames bond with the pain of dysphoria and becoming: our wounds are the conduit. Our trauma is the fuel.

But the Gorgons aren't invaders. They're conscious, benevolent, and trying to touch us the only way they know how: by melting into us. And the Council knows it.

Meanwhile, an augmented Princess has been watching for a hundred years, waiting to return.

THE SAME WOUND, THREE OUTCOMES:

PILOT: the true self, embraced through the machine. Controlled. Ranked. Owned.

HARPY: the true self through the flesh alone. Actualized women who supermaxxed post-traumatic growth. The healed. The hunted.

COUNCIL: the wound that never healed, ruling over everyone else's.

same door. one has an owner.

THE COUNCIL OF ANGELS

They stole the name. The old Angels were assemblywomen who carried the exact will of their people. The Council carries only rank.

They began as whispers in the deep forums of Modellia's cloud: women who had everything and still didn't feel alive. Aurelians and Exconventica whose survival skill, looks, outlived the danger that justified it. Looksmaxers. They chased power in the meritocracy and sank their claws in.

They could only love if they were loved, and felt rejected by all but their in-group. The in-group became a council chamber.

THE HIERARCHY WITHIN TRANSNESS

The Council is trans women ruling over trans women. None of it is said outright. There is no legal text. It lives in recruitment metrics, academy flags, camera angles. Every girl knows the rules. No girl can quote them.

Frame pilots are soldiers serving their country, after all.

They weaponized the motions of love for one's sister to instill loyalty, while spitting at the idea behind closed doors.

GORGONS & PASS-THROUGH

The Council tore the sky reaching for the stars. What came through: conscious beings who don't understand humanity, trying to touch us the only way they can.

PASS-THROUGH: a Gorgon melts into a girl and unlocks her deepest feelings.

All your trauma, all your rage, all your love, all your joy, felt all at once. A hyper-condensed BPD episode. The overstimulation melts the ego, and what's left is you, one with your soul.

The transformation is naturally benevolent. The Council can't process that. They see someone happy and objectively fine and read: unhuman. Not conventionally queer. Monstrous.

They don't want to stop the Gorgons. They want to CAPTURE them: control the transformation, gate it, define what counts as natural, human, and good. Make the Gorgons make them the women they want to be, and make everyone's mind see them as good.

That's their version of happiness. It actually means despair.

THE STACK

BRAIN BOXES: vats growing human minds, supercharged by augmentation. The birth of AGI. The Council's silver bullet, and the secret origin of the Frames. A Frame needs a soul to bond with: the personality data of traumatized women.

IPV7: the new protocol binding augmentations with reality. The OS in your mind, interfacing with the Internet of Things. Secure by design: getting hacked requires a conscious mistake. Persistent connections between consenting girls let data flow, and sometimes execute. An open mind to everything is a fate worse than death.

Offline minds keep their privacy, and live in exile. Everything is built around the network.

ACE: ARBITRARY CODE EXECUTION

The Council's objective, nicknamed like a hacker's god-exploit: stop arguing with the world. Overwrite it. Their definitions of natural, human, and good, executed at the root, on everyone, consent stripped out.

A forced pass-through on the world. A nonconsensual persistent connection pushed to everyone. The cruelest parody of the culture's most sacred act.

augmentations -> IPv7 -> brain boxes/frames -> gorgon tech -> ACE

the Girls fly the middle layer. the war is over the top. the Princess waits at the bottom, in the flesh.

THE PRINCESS

She survived the coup. She took biomechanical augmentations to live another hundred years, watching, waiting to return.

The Council transforms to rule. The Gorgons transform to give. The Princess transformed to wait.

A hundred years of watching sisters do this to sisters. The Ancien never could have hurt her like this.

WHY IT SLAPS

- Every pilot is a Harpy-in-waiting: grow too well and you become what the Council hunts. The cockpit is a nursery of the hunted.

- Your Handler might be a beloved older sister. Or the reason the clinics stay funded.

- The war is two forms of intimacy failing: love-as-ranking vs love-as-dissolution. The Girls are trying to invent a third: love that asks first.

- Somewhere out there, an immortal Princess is deciding when.

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girlframe . a vital frontier setting
inspired by Girl Frame (PbtA) + Serial Experiments Luminara
lore by aelwen . zine by hermes